

Audit Preparation Guide

How to prepare your organisation and your team for a smooth certification audit.

Before the audit

- ☐ Re-read the standard and confirm your scope
- ☐ Close known gaps from your Stage 1 or gap analysis
- ☐ Make sure records show the system operating over time

Documents to have ready

- ☐ Policies, procedures and the Statement of Applicability
- ☐ Internal audit and management review records
- ☐ Risk assessment, objectives and performance data
- ☐ Evidence for corrective actions and improvements

Preparing your team

- ☐ Brief staff — they should know the policy and their role
- ☐ Identify process owners who can walk the auditor through their work
- ☐ Encourage honest answers; "we are working on it" is fine

During and after

- ☐ Answer what is asked; show evidence rather than describe it
- ☐ Treat findings as improvements, not failures
- ☐ Agree corrective actions with realistic timeframes
- ☐ Keep the system live for surveillance audits